CASE STUDY: DIGITAL LITERACY & CYBER AWARENESS

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SECTION A: CONTEXT

In the modern digital era, students are highly dependent on digital tools such as ChatGPT, Canva, coding platforms, and various online resources. While these tools improve efficiency and accessibility, they also create a false sense of competence among students.

Many students focus on completing tasks quickly rather than understanding the concepts behind them. This leads to a gap between digital participation and true digital literacy. Unlike traditional environments, digital actions are permanent and traceable, making responsibility an essential aspect of online behaviour.

SECTION B: DIGITAL IDENTITY AND ETHICS

Digital platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn allow students to build their professional identity and showcase their work globally. However, many students misrepresent their skills by uploading copied projects or claiming expertise without deep knowledge.

This lack of authenticity can damage personal credibility and reduce trust within the digital ecosystem. Additionally, the pressure of comparing achievements with others often leads to anxiety and impulsive actions. Therefore, ethical awareness and honesty are crucial while building a digital presence.

SECTION C: COLLABORATION VS MISUSE

Digital collaboration tools such as Google Docs and shared platforms have made teamwork more efficient and accessible. However, their misuse is evident when only a few members contribute while others remain inactive.

Another issue is plagiarism, where students copy content without understanding it. Although the final output may appear complete, the learning outcome is compromised. Effective collaboration requires equal participation, accountability, and genuine effort from all members.

SECTION D: CYBER AWARENESS AND RESPONSIBILITY

Cybercrime, including phishing, fraud, and identity theft, is rapidly increasing. Even well-informed individuals can become victims due to urgency, emotional pressure, or overconfidence. Preventive measures such as strong passwords and awareness are important but not sufficient. Users must consistently apply safe practices such as verifying links, avoiding suspicious messages, and protecting personal information. Cybersecurity is not only technical but also behavioural.

SECTION E: COMMUNICATION AND DIGITAL ETIQUETTE

Digital communication has replaced face-to-face interaction in many areas. However, many students use informal language even in professional settings, such as emails or workplace communication.

This can create a negative impression and reduce credibility. Maintaining professionalism, clarity, and proper tone in digital communication is essential for building strong relationships and opportunities.

SECTION F: REFLECTION

Initially, digital literacy seemed to be limited to using tools effectively. However, it is much broader and includes responsibility, ethics, and awareness.

This case study highlights the importance of genuine learning, careful online behavior, and practical application of knowledge. It emphasizes that true digital literacy lies in responsible and ethical engagement with technology.

Digital literacy is not defined by how efficiently we use technology, but by how responsibly and ethically we interact with it.